

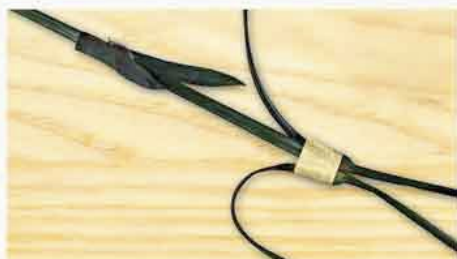
243 Make a flower change color

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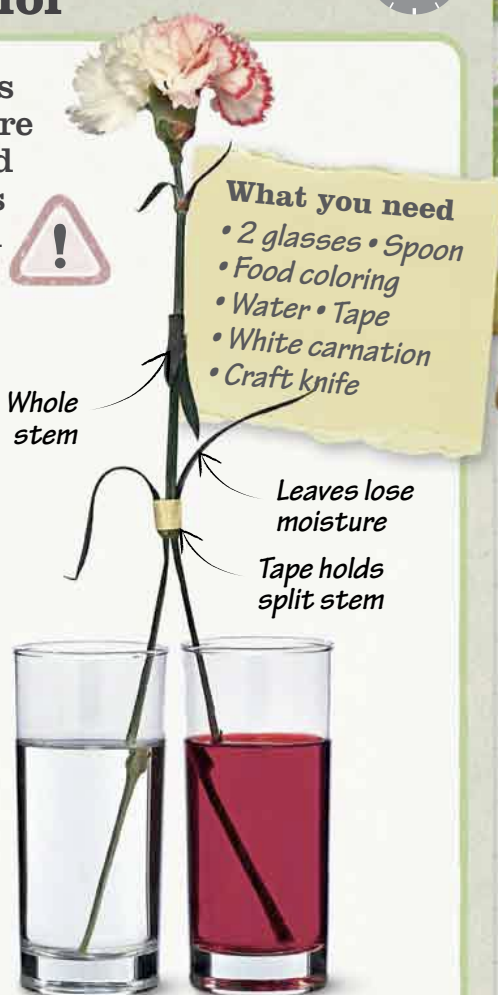
A cut flower uses vessels in its stem to draw water as moisture evaporates from its leaves and head. This experiment shows how this works—and lets you change a flower's color, too!



1 Ask an adult to help. Put the flower on a cutting surface. Slice its stem in two, from the base to halfway up.



2 Tape around the stem just above the top of the cut to prevent splitting. Fill both glasses three-quarters full of water. Add food coloring to one glass; stir well.



What you need

- 2 glasses • Spoon
- Food coloring
- Water • Tape
- White carnation
- Craft knife

3 Put each half-stem into a glass and lean the flower against a window for support. The flower should start to change color after half an hour.

244 Arrange flowers in a jam jar

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Flower stems

Pick some flowers and arrange them in a bunch, then put a rubber band around the stems to keep them in place. Fill a jam jar with water and add the flowers. Make several jars and use them together as a centerpiece.